

Wednesday, 30 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

24° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

21° 16°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

21° 15°

GLASGOW

Rain

19° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 The Prime Minister, Andy Burnham, is reportedly planning to fight the next election on a pledge to change the UK's voting system.**

Mr Burnham wants other parties to join a national commission on electoral reform. This move signals a significant shift in political focus as the Labour conference continues.

POLITICS · UK

- 2 Prince William and Catherine made a surprise visit to support rugby league star Kevin Sinfield's latest charity run.**

Sinfield is on the third day of his endurance challenge, raising vital funds for Motor Neurone Disease charities. The Royal couple's appearance provided a huge boost to the inspiring effort.

CHARITY · UK

- 3 Tragedy has struck in County Durham, where three teenagers have died after a car entered the River Wear.**

Police have recovered the bodies of two teenage boys and a teenage girl from the water. Emergency services were called to the scene on Sunday.

TRAGEDY · UK

- 4 Police in Wales are urgently searching for the mother of a newborn baby whose body was found on a shoreline.**

The heartbreaking discovery was made near Siliwen Road, close to the Menai Strait, on Sunday. Officers are appealing for the mother to come forward for medical help and support.

POLICE · UK

- 5 Former snooker champion Graeme Dott has been jailed for seven years after being found guilty of child sex abuse.**

The 49-year-old was convicted of two charges of lewd and libidinous behaviour. The offences took place against a girl and a boy between 1993 and 2010.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **The acclaimed police drama 'Blue Lights' is set to return, continuing to resonate deeply with audiences in Northern Ireland.**

The award-winning series highlights the complex tensions between police and communities. Its return is highly anticipated by fans.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of 'Blue Lights'? What makes it such compelling viewing?

TV · THIS WEEK

2 **The second series of 'Celebrity Traitors' is about to hit our screens, with 21 stars vying for a £100,000 charity prize.**

The popular reality TV game show returns on Thursday. Viewers will be on the edge of their seats as they try to spot the traitors among the celebrity cast.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to win 'Celebrity Traitors' this year?

TV · THIS WEEK

3 **Hollywood actor Michael Sheen believes his acting background will actually be a disadvantage on 'Celebrity Traitors'.**

Sheen, a self-confessed huge fan of the show, is among the stars taking part. He'll be putting his strategic skills to the test in the hope of winning for charity.

ON AIR – Do you agree with Michael Sheen, or do you think his acting skills will give him an edge?

TV · THIS WEEK

4 **Glastonbury Festival hopefuls are being offered tips and expert advice to boost their chances of securing tickets for 2027.**

Getting tickets for the iconic festival is notoriously difficult. These pointers aim to help fans avoid common mistakes and navigate the booking process successfully.

ON AIR – Have you ever tried to get Glastonbury tickets? Any top tips for others?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **Irish rock legends U2 have celebrated their 50th anniversary by returning to the school where they first formed.**

The band played a special gig in the Dublin playground where they met all those years ago. It was a nostalgic moment for the global superstars.

ON AIR – What's your favourite U2 song, and why?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City have been found guilty of breaching Premier League financial rules between 2009 and 2018.**

The Premier League confirmed the club was guilty of all charges, including 'sham' contracts and an £830 million 'disguised funding scheme'. This verdict could have significant repercussions for the club.

ON AIR – What do you think the fallout from Manchester City's verdict will be?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Following the guilty verdict for Manchester City, attention now turns to what this means for the club and the Premier League.**

BBC Sports Editor Dan Roan has explained the implications of the club being found guilty of all charges related to financial rule breaches. It's a huge moment for English football.

ON AIR – Will this verdict change how other clubs operate in the Premier League?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Former England captain Lawrence Dallaglio is set to sell his 2003 Rugby World Cup winner's medal.**

The rugby legend has been declared bankrupt, leading to the difficult decision to part with one of his most prized possessions. It's a sad turn of events for a sporting icon.

ON AIR – What's the most treasured piece of memorabilia you own?

RUGBY · UK

4 **The Red Roses are set to return to Sunderland's Stadium of Light for the 2027 Women's Six Nations.**

England will play at the venue where they set a record for their Women's Rugby World Cup opener. It's great news for fans in the North East.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see the Red Roses play at the Stadium of Light again?

RUGBY · UK

5 **Aston Villa have sacked manager Natalia Arroyo after a winless start to the Women's Super League season.**

Arroyo's departure comes after two defeats and two draws in their opening four matches. The club will now be searching for a new boss to turn their fortunes around.

ON AIR – Who do you think Aston Villa should appoint as their new Women's Super League manager?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that 'the delightful art of sending handwritten postcards' is experiencing a charming revival.**
Many are rediscovering the joy of a personal touch, finding that a physical card arriving through the letterbox brings a special kind of warmth in our digital age. It's a lovely way to keep in touch and share a little piece of your travels or thoughts.
- 2 Research highlights the soothing effect of 'listening to the gentle patter of rain' on our overall well-being.**
It seems that the natural rhythm of raindrops can reduce stress and improve focus, making rainy days a perfect excuse to slow down and embrace a moment of calm. Perhaps it's nature's own lullaby!
- 3 The trend of 'swapping surplus garden produce with neighbours' is fostering wonderful community spirit.**
From courgettes to apples, people are happily sharing their harvest, reducing food waste and building delightful connections. It's a taste of generosity right on your doorstep.
- 4 Experts are noting a growing interest in 'collecting vintage board games' for family fun.**
Many are seeking out classic games from their childhood, enjoying the nostalgia and the opportunity to introduce them to new generations. It's a wonderful way to bring everyone together for some screen-free entertainment.
- 5 A charming movement sees people 'leaving painted pebbles with uplifting messages' in public parks.**
These small, colourful acts of kindness are designed to bring a smile to passers-by, creating a lovely sense of shared joy and connection in unexpected places. It's a delightful treasure hunt for the soul.
- 6 The simple pleasure of 'visiting a local market for fresh flowers' is becoming a popular weekly ritual.**
People are finding joy in the vibrant colours and fragrant scents, bringing a touch of natural beauty into their homes. It's a little luxury that brightens any room and lifts the spirits.
- 7 A new report suggests that 'the therapeutic act of mending clothes' is gaining popularity.**
Instead of replacing items, many are finding satisfaction in repairing and giving them a new lease of life. It's a sustainable and creative way to care for your wardrobe and perhaps even learn a new skill.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: WARMING THE TEACUP WITH HOT WATER FIRST, EVEN IF IT'S ALREADY A WARM DAY!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: SHAKING THE PACKET VIGOROUSLY TO 'TEST' THE CRUNCHINESS!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of shop' just instantly makes you feel nostalgic, perhaps because of its old-fashioned charm or the specific items it sells?

What's that one shop, from your past or present, that always fills you with a lovely warm, fuzzy feeling every time you step inside or even just think about it? Give us a call and share your delightful memories!

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?

What's a simple, thoughtful gesture that someone has done for you recently that just made your whole day brighter? Let us know, and perhaps we can inspire a little more kindness out there!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, while the third circulates blood to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Squirrels plant thousands of new trees each year by burying nuts and forgetting where they put them.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A group of rhinos is called a crash.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye, despite popular myth.
- The first successful photograph of a human was taken in 1838 by Louis Daguerre, although the person was standing still for a long exposure.
- Sloths can hold their breath longer than dolphins.
- The sound of a thunderclap is actually the air expanding rapidly due to the heat of a lightning bolt.

On this day

Day 273 of the year, 92 days left in 2026. Today Agricultural Reform (Nationalization) Day (São Tomé and Príncipe); Birth of Morelos (Mexico); Blasphemy Day, educates individuals and groups about blasphemy laws and defends freedom of expression; Boy's Day (Poland). Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Ian Ogilvy, English-American actor, playwright, and author
- 2002 — Maddie Ziegler, American dancer and actress
- 1960 — Miki Howard, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1957 — Fran Drescher, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1966 — Gary Armstrong, Scottish rugby player
- 1977 — Roy Carroll, Northern Irish goalkeeper and manager
- 1978 — Candice Michelle, American wrestler
- 1986 — Ben Lovett, Welsh musician and songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1945 — The Bourne End rail crash, in Hertfordshire, England, kills 43.
- 1966 — Bechuanaland declares its independence, and becomes the Republic of Botswana.
- 1975 — Malév Flight 240 crashes into the Mediterranean Sea while on approach to Beirut International Airport in Beirut, Lebanon, killing 60.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: the Germans commence a counter offensive to retake the Nijmegen salient, this having been captured by the allies during Operation Market Garden.
- 1947 — Pakistan joins the United Nations.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1939 — World War II: General Władysław Sikorski becomes prime minister of the Polish government-in-exile.
- 1999 — The Tokaimura nuclear accident causes the deaths of two technicians in Japan's second-worst nuclear accident.

- 1954 — The U.S. Navy submarine USS Nautilus is commissioned as the world's first nuclear-powered vessel.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 274 of the year, 91 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (South Korea); Beginning of the United States' Fiscal Year; Children's Day (El Salvador, Guatemala, Sri Lanka); Christian feast day: Abai (Syriac Orthodox Church). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Cub Koda, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2000)
- 1962 — Paul Walsh, English footballer and sportscaster
- 1980 — Sarah Drew, American actress
- 1939 — Geoffrey Whitehead, English actor
- 1952 — Earl Slick, American rock guitarist and songwriter
- 1986 — Jurnee Smollett, American actress
- 1974 — Keith Duffy, Irish singer-songwriter, dancer, and actor
- 2001 — Luna Blaise, American actress and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2022 — One hundred and thirty-five are killed in a human crush following a football match at Kanjuruhan Stadium in East Java, Indonesia.
- 2003 — The popular and controversial English-language imageboard 4chan is launched.
- 2021 — The 2020 World Expo in Dubai begins. Its opening was originally scheduled for 20 October 2020 but was delayed due to the COVID-19 pandemic.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2015 — Heavy rains trigger a major landslide in Guatemala, killing 280 people.
- 1991 — Croatian War of Independence: The Siege of Dubrovnik begins.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar